Starting a business in Germany

Self-employment permission, trade or freelance activity, taxes and startup advice.

01 / Check whether your current status permits self-employment

- [ ] Read the residence document and any additional conditions.
- [ ] Ask explicitly whether the planned independent activity is permitted.
- [ ] Clarify the route before committing to contracts or premises.

02 / Describe the activity before choosing the registration route

- [ ] Write a precise description of the services you will sell.
- [ ] Clarify classification with the competent authority or qualified adviser.
- [ ] Check professional qualifications, permissions and registration responsibilities.

03 / Plan taxes, records and insurance from the beginning

- [ ] Prepare a realistic budget and separate business records.
- [ ] Confirm tax registration and invoicing requirements before the first invoice.
- [ ] Ask the insurer about coverage for your actual working arrangement.

04 / Use local advice and test the idea carefully

- [ ] Find the chamber or start-up advice service for your activity.
- [ ] Bring your activity description, residence documents and draft budget.
- [ ] Test customer demand while keeping unresolved permissions visible.

Check the current requirements

This is a planning checklist. Requirements depend on status, activity and place of residence. Confirm your circumstances with the responsible authority. Boxes can be checked in the PDF.

Bundesportal — Wohnsitz anmelden

Germany4Ukraine — work and support

Bundesgesundheitsministerium — health insurance

Make it in Germany — starting a business

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My questions and next step

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